Multi-Tenancy Spectrum

> **Day 2 handout.** The four tenancy stances, from cheapest/least-isolated to most-isolated/most-expensive. Tenancy is a customer-and-cost decision, not a pure tech decision — pick with contractual evidence.

Stance	Architecture	Pros	Cons
Shared	One deployment serves all tenants	Lowest cost; easiest ops	Noisy neighbor; weakest isolation
Pooled	One deployment, but per-tenant limits + isolation	Lower cost than dedicated; better isolation	Complex tenant-aware code
Dedicated	One deployment per tenant	Strongest isolation; per-tenant compliance	High cost; complex deployment
Hybrid	Most tenants shared; some dedicated	Match cost to value	Operational overhead of two patterns

The default for FieldPulse's stage

Most B2B SaaS at FieldPulse's stage uses **pooled with per-tenant rate limits**. That's your default; defend anything more isolated.

How to choose

1. **What did your PRD Section 1 customer actually say?** Are any large customers *contractually* expecting dedicated infra?
2. **Pick a stance.** Pooled is the default. Choosing dedicated requires contractual customer evidence.
3. **Capture the revisit trigger** — e.g., "a customer larger than 5x our current largest signs, OR a regulated-industry customer requires dedicated."

The classic mistake

Single-tenant / dedicated without contractual customer evidence is the classic over-promise. It doubles cost to solve a problem no customer has asked you to solve. Don't stake it on a hypothetical.